

In JavaScript, the `array.includes()` method **does not** return the matched value itself; it only returns a **boolean** (`true` or `false`) indicating if the value exists in the array. [W3Schools +3](#)

To get the actual matched value from an array, you should use other built-in methods: [🔗](#)

1. Get the Matched Value with `.find()` [🔗](#)

The most common way to retrieve the first matching element is by using the `find()` method. [🔗](#)

- **How it works:** It returns the **value** of the first element that satisfies the provided testing function.
- **Result if not found:** It returns `undefined` . [🔗 Stack Overflow +2](#)

javascript

```
const fruits = ['apple', 'banana', 'orange'];
const found = fruits.find(fruit => fruit === 'banana');

console.log(found); // Output: "banana"
```

2. Get All Matched Values with `.filter()` [🔗](#)

If your array contains multiple identical values and you want to retrieve all of them, use `filter()` . [🔗](#)

- **How it works:** It returns a **new array** containing all elements that pass the test.
- **Result if not found:** It returns an empty array `[]` . [🔗 Stack Overflow +3](#)

javascript

```
const numbers = [1, 2, 3, 2, 4];
const allMatches = numbers.filter(n => n === 2);

console.log(allMatches); // Output: [2, 2]
```

3. Get the Position with `.indexOf()` [🔗](#)

If you need the **index** (position) of the matched value rather than the value itself, use `indexOf()` . [🔗](#)

- **How it works:** It returns the **first index** at which a given element can be found.
- **Result if not found:** It returns `-1` . [🔗 Stack Overflow +3](#)

javascript



```
const fruits = ['apple', 'banana', 'orange'];
const index = fruits.indexOf('banana');

console.log(index); // Output: 1
```

Summary of Differences

Method 	Returns	Best Use Case
includes()	Boolean (true / false)	Simple existence checks
find()	The matched value	Retrieving a specific object or value
filter()	An array of matches	Getting multiple occurrences
indexOf()	The matched index	Finding where a value is located